

T-Shirt Central 365

Print-on-Demand Marketplace
Platform Overview & Process Documentation

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1. Platform Overview

T-Shirt Central 365 is a print-on-demand marketplace that connects sellers with Printify's network of 1,691+ blank products and 30+ print providers worldwide. Sellers upload their designs, create product listings, and connect their existing stores (Shopify, Etsy, WooCommerce, Wix). When a customer places an order, the seller manually fulfills it through Printify.

The platform is built with a Next.js frontend (port 3005) and a FastAPI backend (port 8000) using SQLite for local development.

2. Tech Stack

Frontend:	Next.js 14, React, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS
Backend:	FastAPI (Python), SQLAlchemy, aiosqlite
Database:	SQLite (tshirtcentral365.db)
Catalog:	Printify API v1/v2 (1,691 blueprints synced)
Ports:	Frontend: 3005 Backend: 8000
Admin:	admin@tshirtcentral365.com / admin12345

3. Product Catalog (Printify Integration)

T-Shirt Central 365 syncs the entire Printify product catalog into a local database via the POST `/api/catalog/sync` endpoint. This pulls all 1,691 product blueprints including:

- Product title, description, and brand
- Up to 9 product images per blueprint (hosted on images.printify.com)
- Category assignment (Apparel, Drinkware, Wall Art, Bags, etc.)
- Featured product flagging

Products are browsable through the public catalog (`/printify/catalog`) and the general products page (`/products`). Both support search, category filtering, and pagination.

4. Store Integrations

Sellers can connect their existing e-commerce stores to T-Shirt Central 365. All connections are managed through `/settings/stores`.

Supported Platforms

- Shopify - Full integration with order sync via Admin API
- Etsy - Connection supported, sync coming soon

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- WooCommerce - Order sync via WC REST API (consumer key/secret)
- Wix - Connection supported, order sync via Wix Stores API (requires instance_id)

Each connection stores: platform, store name, access token, store URL, and a settings JSON field for platform-specific credentials.

5. Product Creation Flow (Designer)

The product designer is a 4-step wizard accessible at /designer:

Step 1: Choose Product

- Search the Printify catalog (1,691 products)
- Select a blueprint (e.g., t-shirt, mug, poster)

Step 2: Upload & Position Design

- Upload PNG, JPG, or SVG design file
- Live preview shows design overlaid on the actual product mockup
- Print area dimensions are extracted from Printify's placeholder data
- Design overlay matches the product's print area aspect ratio
- Scale slider (5-100%) adjusts design size within the print area
- Position controls (arrows) nudge the design up/down/left/right
- Remove Background toggle (CSS multiply blend mode)
- Drag-to-resize handles on the preview corners

Step 3: Product Details

- Set product title and description
- Select print provider (e.g., Printful, Gooten, Textildruck Europa)
- Add tags for searchability

Step 4: Pricing

- Set retail price
- Base cost is 40% of retail (T-Shirt Central 365 fee)
- Seller profit is 60% of retail
- Example: \$29.99 retail = \$18.00 profit per sale

6. Print Provider & Variant System

Each product blueprint has multiple print providers (e.g., Textildruck Europa, Printful, Gooten). Each provider offers different variants with specific options.

Variant Data Structure

- id: Unique variant ID for order creation
- title: Human-readable label (e.g., 'L / Black')
- options: Key-value pairs (e.g., {size: 'L', color: 'Black'})
- placeholders: Print area dimensions and position
- decoration_methods: Printing technique (dtg, embroidery, dye-sublimation)

Print Area Examples

- T-shirt (DTG): 3425 x 3914 px (portrait, 0.88:1 ratio)
- Mug (Dye-sub): 2775 x 1120 px (landscape, 2.48:1 ratio)

- Bottle (Dye-sub): 2100 x 1200 px (landscape, 1.75:1 ratio)
- Cap (Embroidery): 1200 x 525 px (landscape, 2.29:1 ratio)

7. Order Processing (Manual Fulfillment)

T-Shirt Central 365 operates on a manual fulfillment model. Orders are processed by the seller through Printify after receiving payment.

Order Workflow

1. Customer browses catalog and adds product to cart
2. Customer completes checkout and payment (Stripe)
3. Order is created in T-Shirt Central 365 database (status: pending)
4. Seller sees new order in Dashboard (/dashboard) and Orders (/orders)
5. Seller logs into Printify and manually creates the order
6. Seller ships the order and updates status in T-Shirt Central 365

Orders can be viewed at /orders (list) and /orders/[id] (detail). The Printify integration settings at /printify/settings show the connected shop status and provide quick links to the Printify catalog and orders.

8. Key Pages & Routes

Route	Description
/	Homepage with category browsing and featured products
/products	Public product catalog (Printify data, 1,691 items)
/products/[id]	Product detail with image gallery, providers, and variants
/designer	4-step product creation wizard
/dashboard	Seller dashboard with product and order overview
/orders	Order management with status tracking
/settings/stores	Connect Shopify, Etsy, WooCommerce, or Wix
/printify/catalog	Printify catalog browser with category filters
/printify/catalog/[id]	Blueprint detail with provider selection
/printify/products	Products created via Printify
/printify/orders	Printify order management
/printify/settings	Printify API connection settings

9. Backend API Endpoints

Key API routes mounted on the FastAPI backend (localhost:8000):

POST /api/auth/login	Authenticate and receive JWT token
POST /api/auth/register	Create new seller account
GET /api/auth/me	Get current authenticated user
GET /api/catalog	Browse cached Printify catalog (paginated, filterable)
GET /api/catalog/{id}	Get single blueprint details
POST /api/catalog/sync	Sync all blueprints from Printify API
GET /api/catalog/categories/list	List all product categories
GET /api/catalog/brands/list	List all product brands
POST /api/products	Create a new product
GET /api/products	List seller's products
GET /api/orders	List orders (paginated)
GET /api/integrations	List connected stores
POST /api/integrations/shopify	Connect Shopify store
POST /api/integrations/etsy	Connect Etsy store
POST /api/integrations/woocommerce	Connect WooCommerce store
POST /api/integrations/wix	Connect Wix store
GET /api/printify/connection	Check Printify API connection
GET /api/printify/shops	List Printify shops
GET /api/printify/catalog/blueprints/{id}/providers	Get providers for a blueprint
GET /api/printify/catalog/blueprints/{id}/providers/{pid}/variants	Get variants
POST /api/uploads/design	Upload design file (PNG/JPG/SVG)

10. Environment Configuration

Required environment variables (stored in backend/.env):

PRINTIFY_API_TOKEN	# Your Printify API key
PRINTIFY_SHOP_ID	# Your Printify shop ID (e.g., 6906686)
SECRET_KEY	# JWT signing secret
STRIPE_SECRET_KEY	# Stripe payment processing key
WIX_APP_ID	# Wix integration app ID (optional)
WIX_APP_SECRET	# Wix integration app secret (optional)

11. Database Models

Key tables in tshirtcentral365.db:

users	id, email, password_hash, full_name, is_admin, created_at
products	id, title, description, base_cost, retail_price, tags, views, mockup_urls
product_variants	id, product_id, color, size, sku, price, in_stock
orders	id, user_id, status, total, shipping_address, tracking_number
order_items	id, order_id, product_id, variant_id, quantity, price
store_connections	id, user_id, platform, store_name, access_token, settings
catalog_blueprints	id, title, description, brand, images, category, is_featured

catalog_sync_logs

id, synced_at, total_items, status